STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-7500

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **12/04/06**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE	RESOURCES
GENERAL	

SUBJECT	CROSS REFERENCE
UNIVERSAL PRECAUTIONS/INFECTIOUS DISEASE CONTROL	G-3300 UNIFORMS G-7210 EXPOSURE TO BODILY FLUIDS G-10200 EVIDENCE AND PROPERTY

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines for the prevention of infectious disease through the use of universal precautions.

II. Policy:

Employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office must be aware that during the course of their duties they may be exposed directly or indirectly to individuals with contagious diseases including blood-borne and airborne pathogens. The Sheriff's Office shall take all reasonable measures to allow employees to perform their duties in a safe and effective manner. The Sheriff's Office shall provide all employees with the necessary training and access to personal protective equipment.

III. Definitions:

A. BODILY FLUIDS: Fluids that have been recognized by the Center for Disease Control (CDC) as directly linked to the transmission of blood-borne pathogens and to which universal precautions apply. These fluids include blood, semen, blood products, vaginal secretions, cerebrospinal fluid, synovial fluid, and amniotic fluid. For purposes of this policy, bodily fluids shall also include saliva, urine, vomitus, and fecal matter.

IV. Procedures:

A. General:

1. The presence of communicable diseases shall not deter employees from performing their duties to serve and protect in a nondiscriminatory manner. In cases where human life or physical welfare is at stake, employees are

required to act in the most direct and timely manner to protect those who may be threatened.

2. Citizens and other employees who have contracted a communicable disease shall be treated with fairness, courtesy and dignity.

3. An individual's infectious disease status is confidential information that requires only limited disclosure to parties at risk. No Sheriff's Office employee's health information shall be released without written permission. Employees shall be protected from discrimination with regard to health conditions.

4. Employees shall report all on-duty exposures to bodily fluids (see G-7210 Exposure to Bodily Fluids).

B. At-Risk Assignments: In an "at-risk assignment," an employee may be required to provide the first response to an incident in which there is an expectation of contact with bodily fluids. At-risk assignments include but are not limited to:

1. Arrest, investigation and detention procedures that involve physical contact with criminal suspects.

2. Processing property, evidence, or crime scenes.

3. Providing first aid to or the transportation of injured or ill persons.

4. Recovery and/or removal of bodies.

5. Extrication or rescue of persons from vehicles, machinery, or structures.

C. Universal Precautions:

1. Employees shall use protective equipment as appropriate for at-risk assignments unless the employee can demonstrate that its use would have prevented the effective delivery of public safety services or would have imposed an increased risk to his or her safety or the safety of another.

2. To prevent the transmission of communicable and infectious diseases to employees exposed in the course of their duties, the following universal precautions are recommended.

a) Cover all open cuts, abrasions, and sores with waterproof bandages before reporting for duty.

b) Immediately, or as soon as possible, remove garments and/or protective equipment penetrated by bodily fluids and clean underlying skin with warm water and soap.

(1) If the contamination involves an employee's hair or a substantial area of skin, he or she shall be allowed sufficient time to shower and change clothes.

(2) If bodily fluids are splashed in the mouth, eyes, or nose, wash or flush the affected area thoroughly with saline or water.

c) Place contaminated garments and/or protective equipment in designated areas or containers for storage, washing, decontamination, or discard.

d) Wear appropriate gloves when there is potential for contact with bodily fluids and when handling or touching contaminated items or surfaces.

(1) Disposable (single use) latex (or equivalent) gloves shall be worn only once and discarded.

(2) Gloves shall be replaced as soon as possible if they are punctured, torn, or when their ability to function as a barrier is compromised. Latex gloves should not be worn for extended periods (in excess of 30 minutes) without replacement.

(3) Disposable gloves shall be removed by pulling them off inside-out.

e) Hands shall be washed thoroughly with warm water and soap following physical contact with bodily fluids even if gloves are worn.

f) Masks and appropriate eye protection should be worn whenever splashes, sprays, splatters or droplets of blood or other potentially infectious materials may be generated and when eye, nose or mouth contamination may reasonably be anticipated.

g) Plastic mouthpieces or other authorized barrier/resuscitation devices shall be used when performing CPR or mouth to mouth resuscitation.

h) Objects that can penetrate the skin should be handled with extraordinary care and should be considered contaminated items.

(1) Protective (cut resistant) gloves should be worn when searching persons or places, or when working in environments where sharp objects and bodily fluids may be encountered (e.g. accident scenes). Avoid placing hands in areas that have not been visually inspected.

(2) Syringes and needles shall not be recapped, bent, or broken.

(3) Needles shall be placed in puncture-resistant, leak proof containers when collected for evidence, disposal, or transportation (see G-10200 Evidence and Property).

i) If an individual has meningitis or displays signs of tuberculosis, employees should avoid contact with the individual in a confined space, if at all possible.

j) Employees should avoid smoking, eating, drinking, applying makeup, or handling contact lenses near bodily fluid spills or in areas where there is a likelihood of occupational exposure.

D. **Suspect Precautions:** The following precautions are recommended for contact with criminal suspects.

1. Extreme caution should be used when confronted with violent or combative subjects.

2. Employees should never put their fingers in or near a subject's mouth.

3. Employees should not place their hands directly into a subject's possessions (e.g. purses, bags, suitcases, etc.). Contents should be emptied out prior to searching, if possible.

4. If applicable, subjects should empty their pockets after a cursory search for weapons has been completed.

5. Subjects may be asked if they have a known history of infectious or communicable diseases; however, subjects are not required to answer and universal precautions should be taken regardless of the answer.

6. Individuals with bodily fluids on them should be transported separately from other persons.

7. Employees have an obligation to notify relevant persons (e.g. jail staff) during the transfer of custody when a suspect has bodily fluids present on

his or her person or when the suspect advised that he or she has an infectious or communicable disease.

8. Employees should document in the appropriate report (e.g. arrest report) when a suspect has bodily fluids on his or her person or advises he or she has an infectious or communicable disease.

E. **Contaminated Uniforms:** Uniforms or other clothing items that become contaminated by any type of bodily fluid shall be changed immediately. Employees shall not remain on duty in contaminated clothing.

1. Contaminated clothing shall be removed as soon as possible and placed in a biohazard bag. The clothing shall be taken to a professional dry cleaner or washed in hot water with liquid detergent as soon as practical.

2. If a stain remains after cleaning or a dry cleaner will not accept the contaminated item, the employee may request replacement (see G-3300 Uniforms).

F. **Contaminated Sheriff's Office Vehicles:** Sheriff's Office vehicles shall be inspected for signs of bodily fluid contamination by the responsible employee.

1. Any vehicle displaying contamination shall not be put into service until it has been properly cleaned and disinfected.

a) If the contamination is slight, it may be cleaned with a solution of warm water and soap.

b) If the contamination is more extensive, the employee shall notify his or her supervisor. The supervisor shall notify the division commander and arrange of cleaning and disinfection.

G. **Contaminated Equipment:**

1. Non-expendable equipment (e.g. batons, handcuffs, etc.) that has been contaminated shall be cleaned as soon as possible. A solution of one (1) part bleach to ten (10) parts water will safely disinfect equipment.

2. Leather gear should not be exposed to bleach. Leather items should be cleaned with warm water and soap.

3. Latex (or equivalent) gloves should be worn when cleaning contaminated equipment.

4. Contaminated expendable items (e.g. pens, paper, etc.) should be disposed of properly.